

Dr. Christopher Dillon

Global Lead Data Scientist · Head of Data

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Northern Ireland

EXPERIENCE

Global Lead Data Scientist

Jan 2025 - Present

Nexus Brands Group

Defined and built the data strategy, infrastructure, and team for a group of 18 businesses. Co-founded the Global Finance and Data Analytics Department — owning the full stack from data warehousing and ETL through to executive dashboards and advanced analytics.

- **Impact:** Increased OTIF by **25%**, identified **millions** in excess & obsolete inventory, detected **~1% of revenue** in out-of-stock sales loss
- **Team Leadership:** Built and lead a team of PhD-level data scientists and engineers, supporting senior leadership across the group
- **Full-Stack Data:** Delivered centralised global reporting and Streamlit dashboards (with Entra SSO), replacing fragmented legacy systems with a universal architecture
- **KPI Strategy:** Designed EOS Level 10 executive scorecard aligning KPIs with operational priorities
- **Advanced Analytics:** Customer segmentation, margin optimisation, and strategic growth initiatives
- **AI-Assisted Development:** Leveraging Claude Code to accelerate delivery of data products and pipelines

European Data Scientist

Apr 2023 - Jan 2025

Nexus Brands Group

Built the data function from scratch for 5 European businesses across tattoo, beauty, and pet grooming supply. Consolidated fragmented data sources into a unified data warehouse, enabling consistent automated reporting across all entities. Promoted to Global Lead Data Scientist based on this work.

Data Scientist

May 2022 - Apr 2023

Christies Direct (now part of Nexus Brands Group)

Established the Data Science function from scratch at one of the world's largest pet-grooming supply companies. Created unified reporting across Christies and sister company Transgroom. Promoted to European Data Scientist as the business was acquired into Nexus Brands Group.

Astrophysics PhD

Sep 2017 - Feb 2022

Queen's University Belfast

Joint venture with Radox Laboratories developing statistical techniques for astrophysical and biomedical analysis. Developed algorithms for large-scale statistical analysis of below-noise-floor signals, leading to novel discoveries of stellar nanoflares. Created image feature recognition software achieving **98.8%** reduction in processing times (saving **600+ seconds**), key component of biochip diagnostics pipeline in **\$12B** industry.

PUBLICATIONS

2023	Nanoflare Activity on Fully Convective M-dwarf Stars Grant et al. The Astrophysical Journal
2020	Statistical Evidence for Stellar Nanoflare Signals in M-type Lightcurves Dillon et al. The Astrophysical Journal
2019	Monte Carlo Techniques for Nanoflare Detection in Solar Active Regions Jess et al. The Astrophysical Journal

EDUCATION

MSci Physics, First Class Honours

Sep 2013 - Jun 2017

Queen's University Belfast

Seagate bursary recipient. Head of peer mentor scheme.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES

Python
SQL
R

DATA SCIENCE

Machine Learning
Predictive Modelling
A/B Testing
NLP / Time Series

DATA ENGINEERING

Data Warehousing
ETL Pipelines
Data Modelling

TOOLS

Streamlit
Git / Docker
Claude Code / AI Dev

LEADERSHIP

Building Data Teams
Hiring & Recruitment
Mentoring & Development
Data Strategy

MANAGEMENT

Stakeholder Management
Cross-functional Delivery
Agile / Scrum

DOMAIN

E-commerce Analytics
Customer Segmentation
Supply Chain / OTIF

INDUSTRY

Retail / Wholesale
Biomedical Diagnostics
Astrophysics Research